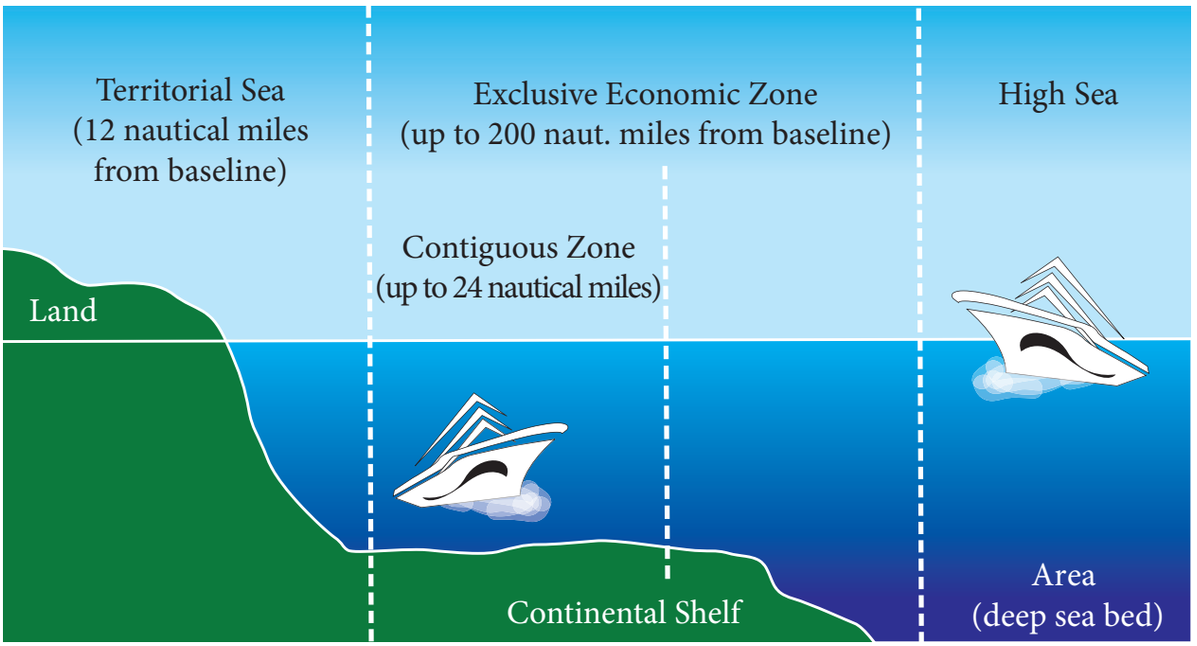


Figure 5.5 Maritime Zones

Fact File

A nautical mile is based on the circumference of the earth, and is equal to one minute of a degree of latitude. A nautical mile is equivalent to 1,852 metres. Nautical miles are used in Navigational charts.

5.8 Relief of ocean

The bottom of the ocean has a variety of landforms just as it is seen on the earth's surface. There are large mountain ridges, deep depressions, flat plains, basins and volcanoes (Figure 5.7). The configuration of an ocean floor is shown with the help of a '**Hypsometric curve**' or '**Hypsographic curve**'. It is a graph denoting the proportion of a landmass standing above or below the sea level.

Fact File

Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (**INCOIS**) with its Marine Satellite Information Services uses the remotely sensed sea surface temperature (SST) to identify the locations of fish aggregation. The details of the Potential Fishing Zones (PFZ) are then disseminated to the fishermen once in every three days along the Indian Coast by displaying the details in the Lighthouse in their respective regional language (Figure 5.6).

Continental shelf

Continental shelf is the seaward extension of land that lies under the sea water. It occupies 7% of the sea floor. The continental shelf slopes gently away from the land and is covered with shallow seas with an average depth of 200

TN_Govt_Geography_XI_Std Unit_05.indd 113 15-12-2021 16:42:51